ETCSL 1.7.4 — The Flood story

▼ Contents

Why it matters here 1
Files 1
Line numbering 2
ETCSL bibliography (secondary literature, from the XML header) 2
Manuscripts listed by ETCSL 2
Assessment 2

- **Editors:** ETCSL project (J. Black, G. Cunningham, E. Robson, G. Zólyomi et al.), Oxford 1998–2006
- **URLs:** transliteration https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/cgi-bin/etcsl.cgi?text=c.1.7.4&display=Crit&charenc=gcirc ; translation https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/cgi-bin/etcsl.cgi?text=t.1.7.4 ; XML from OTA 2518 (see `../_bulk/`). ORACC: https://oracc.museum.upenn.edu/epsd2/literary/Q000357 (see ../../ORACC/).
- **Retrieved:** 2026-10-16 (live site down; HTML from Wayback Machine raw captures; XML from Oxford Text Archive)
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Why it matters here

The Sumerian Flood Story ("Eridu Genesis", Jacobsen's name): creation of mankind and animals, kingship descends from heaven, five antediluvian cities (Eridug, Bad-tibira, Larag, Zimbir, Šuruppag), the gods' oath to destroy mankind, Enki's warning to king **Ziusudra** through the wall (Segment C 18–27 — cf. Gilg. XI 20–22 'Reed-fence, reed-fence! Wall, wall!'), the flood of seven days and seven nights, Utu's light entering the boat, sacrifice, and Ziusudra's grant of eternal life in Dilmun (Segment E). Direct Sumerian ancestor of the Atra-ḫasīs/Gilgameš XI tradition. Only one main manuscript (CBS 10673+10867, Nippur, OB; Poebel 1914 = PBS 5 no. 1) — roughly a third of the text survives.

Files

- `b174--etcsl-bibliography.htm`
- `c.1.7.4--etcsl-cgi-transliteration.html`
- `c.1.7.4.xml`
- `t.1.7.4--etcsl-cgi-translation.html`

- t.1.7.4.xml
- translation.md
- transliteration.md

transliteration.md (89 composite lines) and translation.md are clean UTF-8 conversions of the XML (conventions at the top of each file); the .xml files are the authoritative source; the --etcsl-cgi-*.html files are the website display (Unicode, edition 2).

Line numbering

ETCSL composite line numbers (with segments/versions where the composition has them). Translation paragraphs carry the line range they cover.

ETCSL bibliography (secondary literature, from the XML header)

- Römer 1993a 448-458 translation, commentary
- Kramer 1983 translation, commentary
- Jacobsen 1981 composite text, translation, commentary
- Jacobsen 1987 145-150 translation, commentary
- Pettinato 1971 translation, commentary, composite text ll. 37-50; 84-100
- Krecher 1996a composite text, translation electronic source
- Lambert and Millard 1969 138-145 translation, commentary, score transliteration by M. Civil

Manuscripts listed by ETCSL

- CBS 10673 Nippur 37-50, 84-100, 135-162, 201-217, 251-261 Civil 1969: 138 suggests that bilingual CT 46, 5 may belong to missing part of col iii; STVC 87 B may also belong -- based only on similar content. Kramer 1983 follows Civil 1969's numbering; TUAT follows Jacobsen 1981's.

Assessment

Standard free composite with translation; frozen in 2006 — check for newer manuscripts/editions (see ../../ORACC/ and the notes above).